LESSON 2

Goin' Home

The slow tune from Dvořák's *New World* Symphony, written in 1893 while he was far from home in America. Later it was given words: a song about going home.

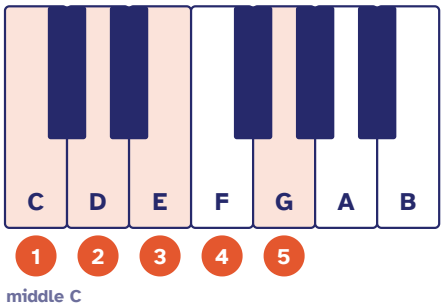
IN THIS SONG **the C position** **a skip: E up to G** **the semibreve** **fingers 1 2 3 5**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

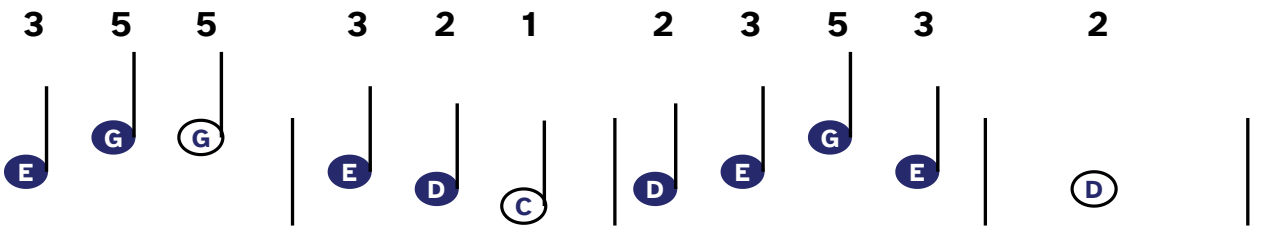
THE WOW MOMENT
Play it with the string quartet. Scan the code, choose the quartet, and your notes ride on real strings, the way Dvořák heard them. Then stamp your **passport**: Dvořák.

1 Meet the song

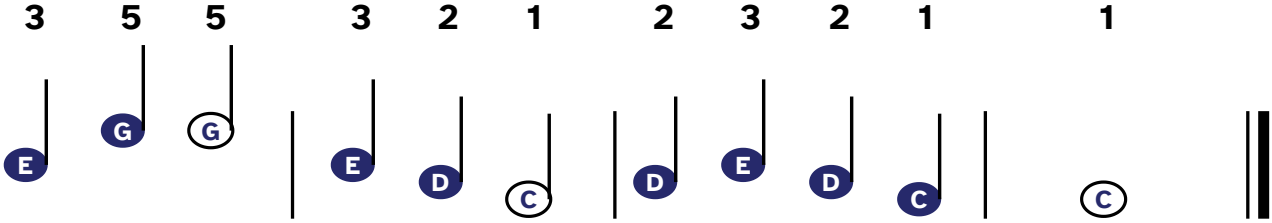
Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand: the C position. Thumb on middle C, one finger on each key up to G. This song uses 1, 2, 3 and 5.
The skip. E jumps up to G, right over F.



5



☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words** ☐ **Sang the letter names**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT

Count 1 2 3 4 in every bar: four beats a bar now.
Walk on a beat; hold a minim for two; hold a semibreve for the whole bar.

THE NOTES



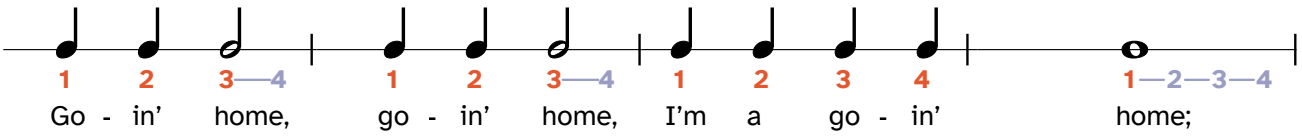
crotchet: walk
1 beat

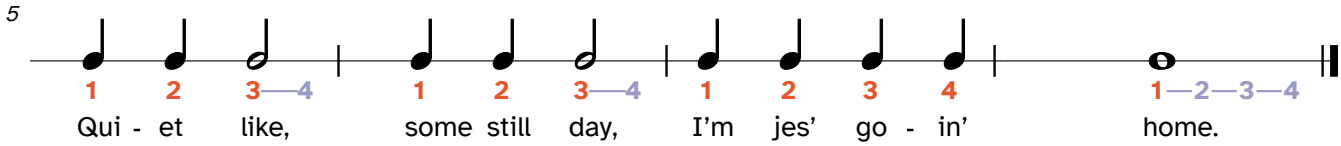


minim: hold
2 beats



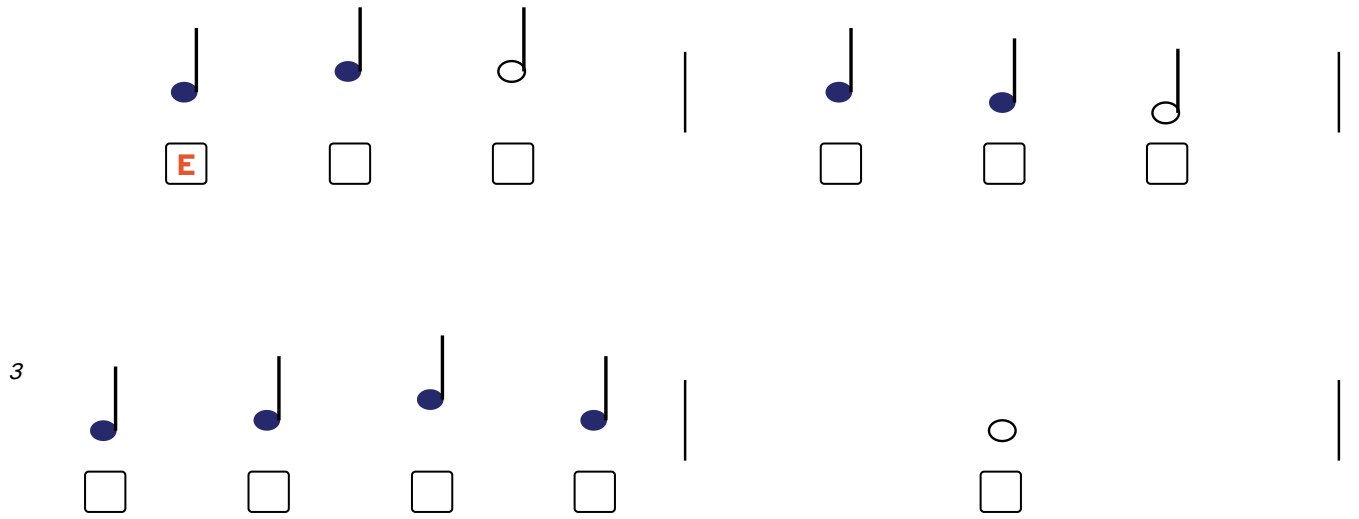
semibreve: hold-2-3-4
4 beats





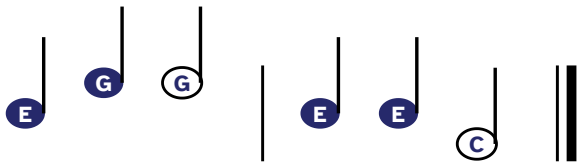
THE NOTES

Write C, D, E or G in each box of the first four bars. Then circle the skip: E straight up to G.



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



- ☐ **Said it in time**
- ☐ **Clapped and counted**
- ☐ **Wrote the letter names**
- ☐ **Found the skip**
- ☐ **Spotted the mistake**

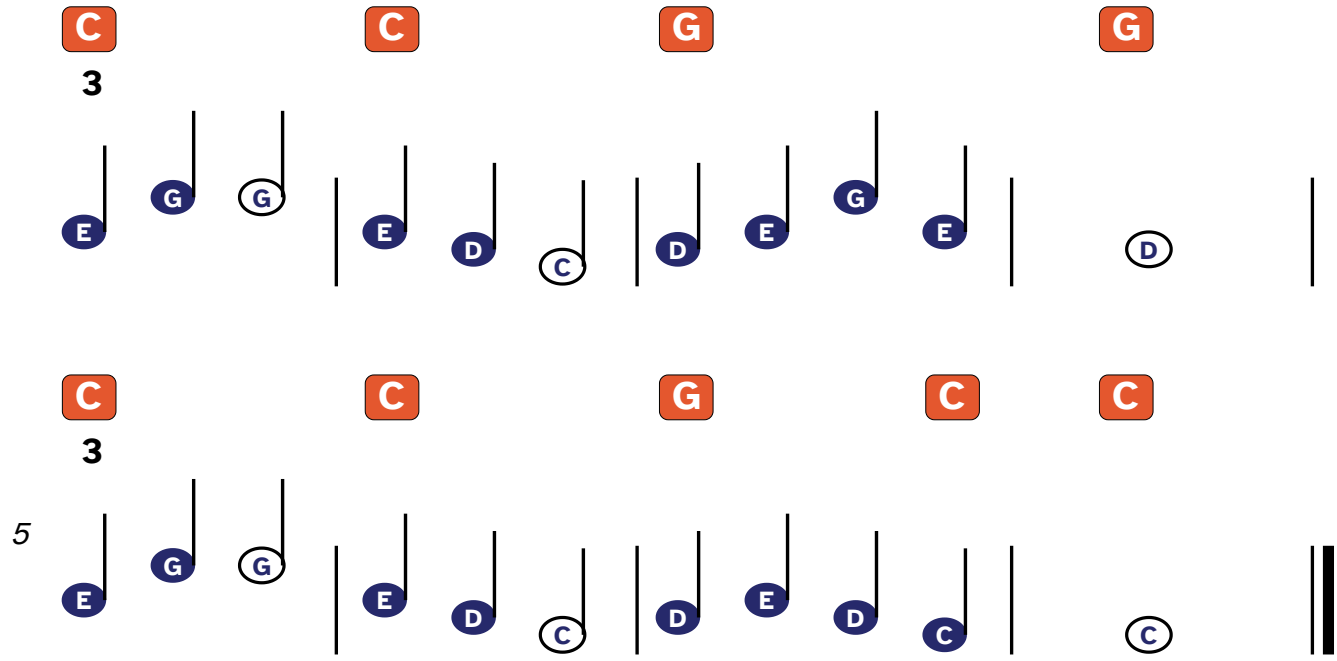
3 Lead sheet

The tune, with only the chord names above it. You play the tune; the band on the listening page plays the names.

THE NAMES

A name tells the band which chord to play under the tune. Your left hand learns to play them from Lesson 4.

C G



1 Find where the name changes

2 Play the tune with the band (the listening page): the band plays the names

3 Say the names out loud in time while the band plays

4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words ☐ I can find the skip

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the band				

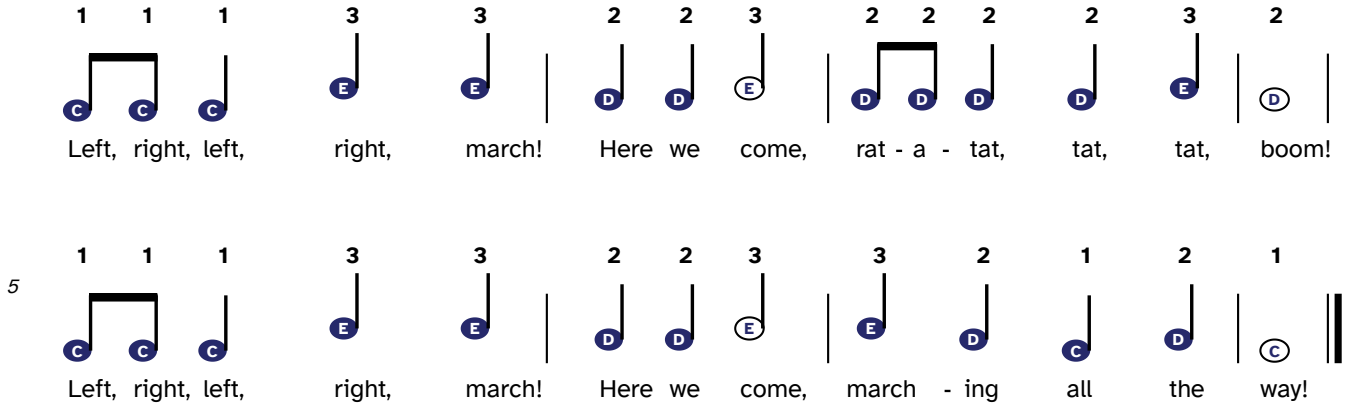
LISTEN BACK ☐ I recorded it ☐ It sounded right

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways: a march on three keys, then a train that jumps the skip.

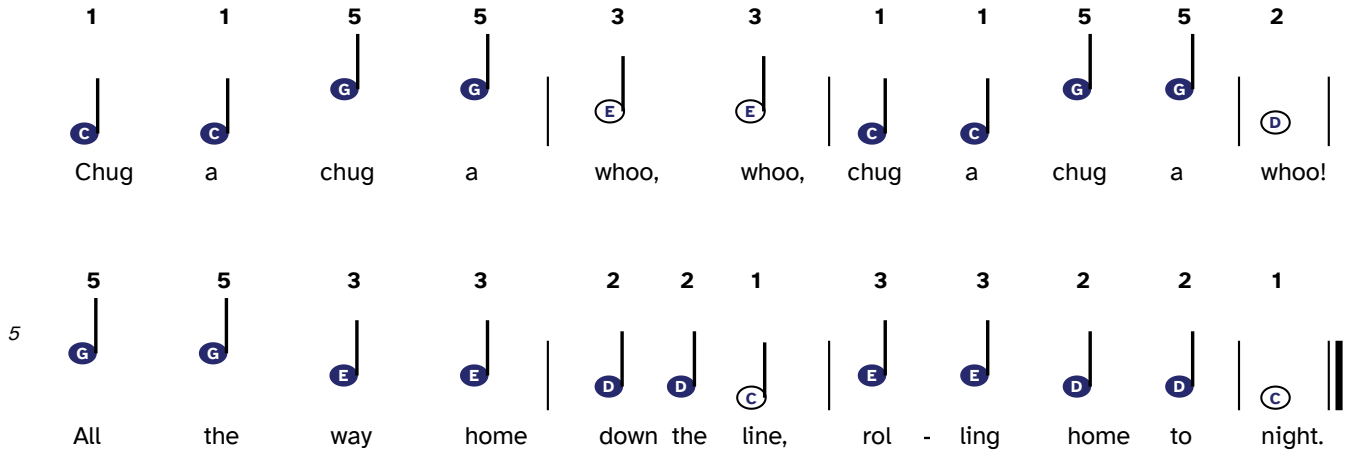
TOY SOLDIERS

A march, crisp and steady: C, D and E, a skip from C to E, and one long BOOM to hold. Sing along!



NIGHT TRAIN

A train rolling home through the dark: thumb and 5 jump C to G; the long whoo is a semibreve.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- [ ] **Eyes closed: feel the skip, E up to G**
- [ ] **Sleepy: slow and soft, like evening**
- [ ] **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, twice
3. Lead sheet: the tune with the band
4. Play it with the quartet

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

- [ ] **Played Toy Soldiers**
- [ ] **Played Night Train**